



CONCEPT TEST REPORT · INNOVATION STAGE-GATE

ProteinPeak Chocolate Almond

Q3 2026 concept test read — purchase intent, cohort breakouts and the cannibalization gate for the next Wellness Hero flavor.

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Field period June 22 – July 11, 2026 · n = 1,000

For the ProteinPeak stage-gate (Sage Park / Audrey Vance)

THE VERDICT

Executive summary — clears the gate

64%

Top-two-box purchase intent

+9 pp

Above the 55% action standard

8 pp

Substitutional overlap (gate: <12pp)

n=1,000

Sample, three cohorts

ProteinPeak Chocolate Almond clears the action standard decisively. Top-two-box purchase intent is **64%** against Acme's 55% cereal-innovation standard — 6 points above the most recent launch-SKU pre-test and 11 points above the five-year category-innovation benchmark. Intent is strongest exactly where it should be: the protein-curious cohort at 71%.

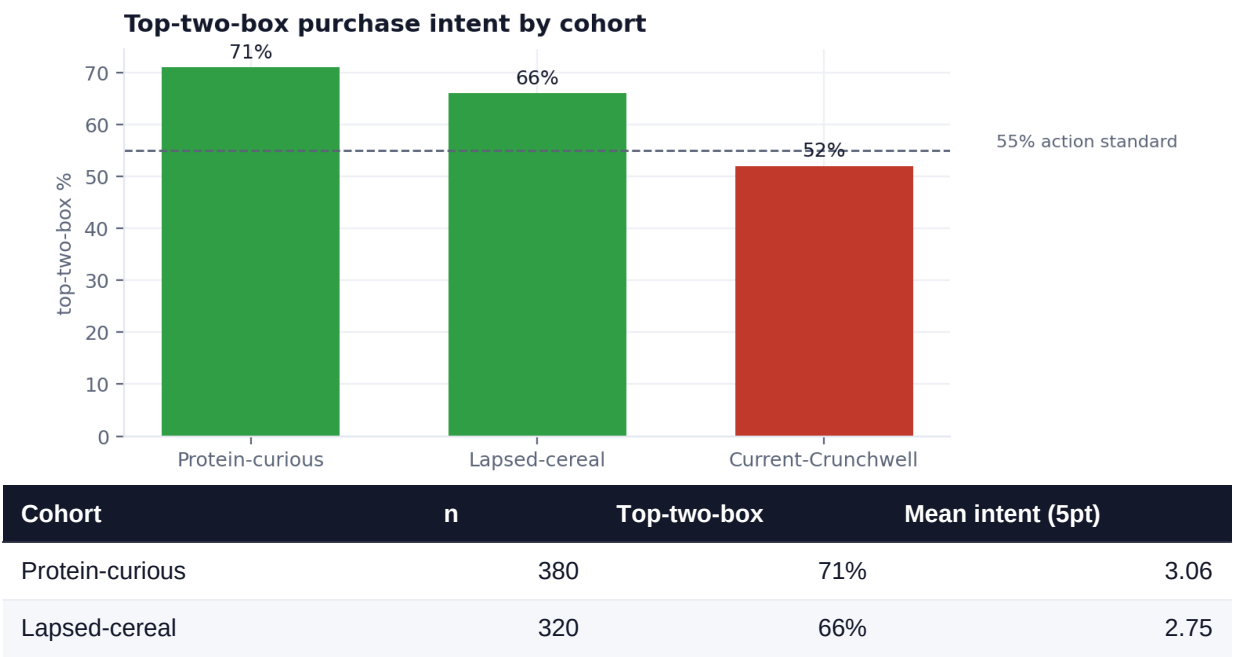
Critically, it passes the cannibalization gate. Substitutional overlap with the current launch SKU is 8 pp — under the 12 pp steerco threshold — and overlap with the Crunchwell core is negligible (2 pp substitutional). This is additive volume, not a reshuffle. Recommendation: greenlight to the next stage-gate, with a competitive watch on Field & Honey's chocolate filing.

Recommendation

Advance ProteinPeak Chocolate Almond to development stage-gate. The concept is additive, on-trend with the protein-curious cohort, and time-sensitive given the competitive flag below.

PURCHASE INTENT

Strong where it matters

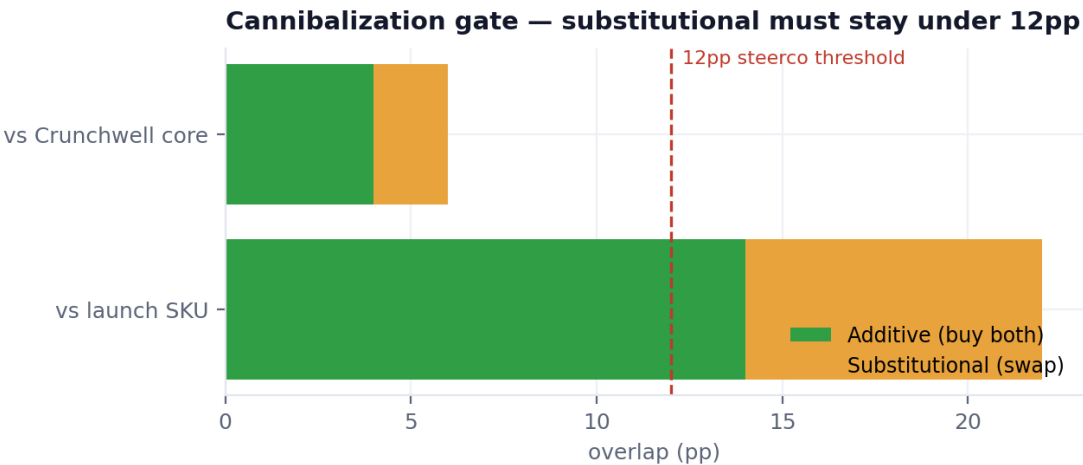


Cohort	n	Top-two-box	Mean intent (5pt)
Current-Crunchwell	300	52%	2.20

The protein-curious and lapsed-cereal cohorts — the households driving the category's protein migration — both clear the standard comfortably. Current-Crunchwell buyers under-index at 52%, which is the right result: this product should recruit new and returning households, not simply churn the existing base. A Numerator panel cross-check matched the protein-curious test cohort within 3 pp on key behaviors.

THE CANNIBALIZATION GATE

Additive, not substitutional



Total overlap with launch-SKU buyers is 22% — but the composition matters more than the headline. 14 pp of that overlap is **additive** (households that will buy both flavors) and only 8 pp is **substitutional** (households that swap). Eight points sits below the 12 pp steerco threshold, so the concept passes. Overlap with the Crunchwell core is only 6%, of which 2 pp is substitutional — Chocolate Almond does not erode the family-cereal franchise.

CONTEXT

Demand tailwind, competitive clock

- **U&A overlay:** chocolate-as-a-breakfast-flavor preference indexes +14 pp above the category average within the protein-curious cohort — the concept is riding a real behavioral tailwind, not just survey enthusiasm.
- **Competitive flag:** Larksfield filed a "Field & Honey Chocolate Crunch" trademark on April 22, 2026, pointing to a likely Q4 launch. Advancing now preserves a first-mover window in protein-chocolate.
- **Risk:** if development slips past the Field & Honey launch, the concept loses its differentiation premium and the cannibalization math should be re-tested.

Sources: `concept_test_chocolate_almond` seed (Test_ID CT_CHOC_ALMOND_2026Q3), `ua_study_responses`, `competitor_launches` (LCH00032), `households` × `household_transactions` for panel validation. All figures from the Acme synthetic dataset.